

Large Numbers – Place Value to Lakhs

Indian Number System | Ones → Tens → Hundreds → Thousands → Lakhs

■ Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- ① Identify and name place values from **Ones** up to **Lakhs**.
- ② **Read and write** large numbers using the Indian comma system.
- ③ Find the **place value** of any digit in a number up to 6 digits.
- ④ **Compare** large numbers using place value.
- ⑤ Recognise large numbers in **real-life** contexts.

■ What Are Large Numbers?

Large numbers are any numbers **bigger than 999**. Once we go past 999, we need more digits — and more place values! In India we use a special grouping system that goes all the way up to **Lakhs**.

■ The Indian Place Value Chart

Place	Ones	Tens	Hundreds	Thousands	Ten Thousands	Lakhs
Value	1	10	100	1,000	10,000	1,00,000
Digits	1 digit	2 digits	3 digits	4 digits	5 digits	6 digits
Example	7	70	700	7,000	70,000	7,00,000

1■■ Ones, Tens & Hundreds

Let's look at the number 345:

3Hundreds =
300**4**

Tens = 40

5

Ones = 5

 $300 + 40 + 5 = 345$ ← This is called **expanded form!****Ones Place**Single units. The digit **5** in 345 means just 5 ones.**Tens Place**Groups of 10. The digit **4** in 345 means 4 tens = 40.**Hundreds Place**Groups of 100. The digit **3** in 345 means 3 hundreds = 300.■ *Tip: The place of a digit tells us its value!***2■■ Thousands, Ten Thousands & Lakhs****Let's look at the number 4,25,637:****4**Lakhs =
4,00,000**2**Ten Thous. =
20,000**5**Thousands =
5,000**6**Hundreds =
600**3**

Tens = 30

7

Ones = 7

 $4,00,000 + 20,000 + 5,000 + 600 + 30 + 7 = 4,25,637$ **Thousands Place**1,000 has **4 digits**. Example: 5,000 = five thousand.**Ten Thousands Place**10,000 has **5 digits**. Example: 25,000 = twenty-five thousand.**Lakhs Place**1 Lakh = **1,00,000** — that's 6 digits!
Example: 3,00,000 = three lakh.■ *1 lakh = 100 thousands = 1,00,000*

In the **Indian number system**, we use commas to separate digits into groups:

Starting from the **right**:

1. Place a comma after the first **3** digits → separates Hundreds from Thousands.
2. Then place a comma after every **2** digits → separates Thousands from Lakhs.

Example: 123456 → **1,23,456**

Remember: The Indian comma pattern is different from the international system!

International: 123,456 | Indian: 1,23,456

Number (no commas)	Indian System	Read as
45678	45,678	Forty-five thousand six hundred seventy-eight
123456	1,23,456	One lakh twenty-three thousand four hundred fifty-six
350000	3,50,000	Three lakh fifty thousand
987654	9,87,654	Nine lakh eighty-seven thousand six hundred fifty-four
100000	1,00,000	One lakh

■ Reading Large Numbers Aloud

Step-by-step: How to read 1,23,456

Step	Group	Digits	Say
1	Lakhs	1	One lakh
2	Ten Thousands	23	Twenty-three thousand
3	Hundreds	4	Four hundred
4	Tens & Ones	56	Fifty-six
✓	Full number	1,23,456	One lakh twenty-three thousand four hundred fifty-six

■ Tips for Reading Aloud

- Always start reading from the **left** (highest place value).
- Say the **place name** after you read each group of digits.
- Use the commas as natural **pauses** when reading.
- Practice with a partner — one person writes, the other reads aloud!

■■ Comparing Large Numbers

Rule: Look at the **highest place value** first. Start from the left and compare digit by digit. The number with the bigger digit in the highest place is the larger number!

Number A	Number B	Compare	Winner
54,321	45,321	Ten Thous: $5 > 4$	54,321 ✓
2,45,678	1,98,765	Lakhs: $2 > 1$	2,45,678 ✓
3,67,000	3,70,000	Ten Thous: $6 < 7$	3,70,000 ✓
5,00,000	4,99,999	Lakhs: $5 > 4$	5,00,000 ✓

Large Numbers in Real Life

Counting Money	Population	Distance
If you save ₹1,25,000, each digit tells you how many lakhs, thousands, hundreds and rupees you have. Place value helps you count and manage money!	India has over 140 crore people! A city might have 5,00,000 people. Place value helps us read and understand these huge population figures.	Delhi to Mumbai $\approx$ 1,400 km. Earth to Moon $\approx$ 3,84,000 km! Scientists and engineers use large numbers every day — and so can you.

Fun Activity: Build Your Own Number!

Choose any digit (0–9) for each place value box. Start from Lakhs and fill in all the way to Ones. Then write your complete number!

Lakhs	Ten Thousands	Thousands	Hundreds	Tens	Ones

My number in Indian system: _____ Read aloud as:

Quiz Time!

Q1. [True or False]

In the number 2,45,678, the digit 4 is in the Ten Thousands place.

Q2. [Multiple Choice]

1 lakh equals:

- A) 1,000
 - B) 10,000
 - C) 1,00,000
 - D) 10,00,000
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Q3. [Fill in the Blank]

The number 3,50,000 is read as: 'Three lakh _____ thousand.'

Q4. [Write & Solve]

Write 987654 in the Indian number system with commas. Then write it in words.

Q5. [Compare]

Circle the greater number: 4,78,321 or 4,87,123 Explain how you decided:

■ Recap: What We Learned

Understanding Place Value

Reading & Writing Numbers

Comparing Numbers

Place value tells us the worth of each digit. We learned places from Ones all the way up to Lakhs!	Write large numbers with Indian commas (1,23,456) and read them aloud group by group, starting from the left.	To compare, look at the highest place value first. The number with the bigger digit in that place is larger.
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■ Answer Key (Teacher Reference)

Q1. TRUE — In 2,45,678 the digit 4 is in the Ten Thousands place (value = 40,000).

Q2. C) 1,00,000 — One lakh equals one hundred thousand.

Q3. Fifty — 3,50,000 = Three lakh fifty thousand.

Q4. 987654 → **9,87,654** = Nine lakh eighty-seven thousand six hundred fifty-four.

Q5. 4,87,123 is greater. Both have 4 lakhs, but Ten Thousands: $8 > 7$.

■ *Keep practising large numbers — they are everywhere around us!* ■

Grade 3 Mathematics | Large Numbers: Place Value to Lakhs | Indian Number System